Question ID e25f0807

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear functions	

ID: e25f0807

x	y
-12	-45
6	45

The table shows two values of x and their corresponding values of y. The graph of the linear equation representing this relationship passes through the point $\left(\frac{1}{4},\ a\right)$. What is the value of a?

ID: e25f0807 Answer

Correct Answer:
16.25, 65/4

Rationale

The correct answer is $\frac{65}{4}$. The linear relationship between x and y can be represented by the equation $y = mx + b$, where m and b are constants. It's given in the table that when $x = -12$, $y = -45$. Substituting -12 for x and -45 for y in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $-45 = -12m + b$, which can be rewritten as $-45 + 12m = b$. It's also given in the table that when $x = 6$, $y = 45$. Substituting 6 for x and 45 for y in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $45 = 6m + b$, which can be rewritten as $45 - 6m = b$. Substituting $-45 + 12m$ for b in this equation yields $45 - 6m = -45 + 12m$. Adding $6m$ to both sides of this equation yields $45 = -45 + 18m$. Adding 45 to both sides of this equation yields $90 = 18m$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 18 yields $5 = m$, or $m = 5$. Substituting 5 for m, -12 for x, and -45 for y in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $-45 = 5(-12) + b$, or $-45 = -60 + b$. Adding 60 to both sides of this equation yields $15 = b$. Therefore, $m = 5$ and $b = 15$. Substituting 5 for m and 15 for b in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $y = 5x + 15$. Thus, the equation $y = 5x + 15$ represents the linear relationship between x and y. It's also given that the graph of the linear equation representing this relationship passes through the point $\left(\frac{1}{4}, a\right)$. Substituting $\frac{1}{4}$ for x and a for y in the equation $y = 5x + 15$ yields $a = 5\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) + 15$, which is equivalent to $a = \frac{5}{4} + 15$, or $a = \frac{65}{4}$. Note that 65/4 and 16.25 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Question Difficulty:
Hard